Real Issues in the SRS (Worth Fixing)

Review notes with problem statements and suggested replacement wording

Issue 2: FR-2.1 “agent runs continuously per user”

What it says now

“The agent shall run continuously per user... and discover opportunities from web sources...”

The problem

It reads as if every user has their own agent that searches the internet by itself. With 500 users, that’s 500 agents searching the same scholarship sites and calling the LLM 500 times to read the same page. That is slow and expensive, and it contradicts NFR-19, which says LLM spend must be capped and bulk work should be cheap.

What to write instead

Split the agent into two parts:

- **Shared discovery (once for everyone):** find, read, structure, de-duplicate and scam-check each opportunity one time, and store it in the shared Opportunity table.
- **Per-user matching (cheap):** for each user, score the new opportunities against their profile.

> *Suggested wording: “FR-2.1a: The system shall discover and extract opportunities once, on a schedule, into a shared Opportunity table. FR-2.1b: For each user, the agent shall score new and updated opportunities against the user’s profile, on a schedule and after profile changes.”*

Issue 3: Backups (35 days) vs. deletion (30 days)

What it says now

Account deletion and backups are specified with different time limits:

- NFR-10 / FR-1.7: account deletion completes within **30 days**.
- Section 7.3: backups are kept up to **35 days**.

The problem

A user deletes their account on day 0. Their data is gone from the live database, but it still sits in backups until day 35. So your promise (“deleted within 30 days”) is false for 5 days. This matters legally because of Algeria’s Law 18-07 and GDPR.

What to write instead

Pick one:

- **Option A (simplest):** change the backup rotation to **30 days or less**.
- **Option B:** keep 35 days and add a sentence: “Deleted data is removed from live systems within 30 days and from backups within 35 days; users are informed of this in the privacy policy.”

Issue 4: NFR-13 has two targets

What it says now

“A new user completes intake in under 5 minutes and sees the first matches within 24 hours (target: within 1 hour).”

The problem

Which one is the requirement, 24 h or 1 h? QA can't write a pass/fail test for two numbers. It also affects design: 24 h allows a nightly batch job, while 1 h requires matching to run right after intake.

What to write instead

Pick one number, for example:

> *"A new user completes intake in under 5 minutes and sees their first matches within 1 hour of finishing intake."*

Issue 5: FR-2.7 to FR-2.10 aren't mapped to any use case

What it says now

The traceability table (9.4) links UC-2 to FR-2.1 through FR-2.6 only. These are not linked to any use case:

- FR-2.7 learning from feedback
- FR-2.8 re-checking saved opportunities
- FR-2.9 pause/resume the agent
- FR-2.10 the saved list with statuses (Saved, Preparing, Applied, Result received)

The problem

FR-2.10 is the Saved tab, one of your four main screens, and no user story describes it. Design, dev and QA each assume something different. FR-2.9 (pause/resume) has no story either.

What to write instead

Add a use case, for example:

> ***UC-8 Manage saved opportunities and the agent.*** *Actor: Seeker. Flow: open the Saved tab, change an opportunity's status (Saved → Preparing → Applied → Result received), remove it, or pause/resume the agent and adjust its search scope. Covers FR-2.9, FR-2.10 (and FR-2.7, FR-2.8 when built).*

Then update the traceability table (9.4) and the use case list in section 3.

Issue 6: "Delivered cards saved" in the evaluation table

What it says now

Section 8.4: "At least 40% of delivered **cards** saved."

The problem

"Cards" are the swipe deck, which is a next-phase feature. This week, users see matches in a list and notifications. The wording refers to something that doesn't exist in v1.0, and the metric is unclear about what counts as "delivered".

What to write instead

> *"At least 40% of delivered matches (shown in the Radar list or sent as an alert) are saved."*

Also change "cards" to "matches" in the MVP exit criteria in 9.1 if it appears there.

Issue 10: No concrete source list

What it says now

The agent discovers opportunities from “web sources, partner feeds, organization submissions.” The source list per market is an open question (9.3).

The problem

The agent can’t search “the internet” in general. It needs specific websites or feeds. Until someone names them, Dev C can’t build or test extraction, and you can’t measure the targets (95% extraction accuracy, under 2% expired items).

What to write instead

Add an appendix, “Initial source list”, with 10 to 15 entries and, for each: name, URL, type (scholarship, job, fellowship, etc.), access method (RSS, public page, API), region and language, and a terms-of-use note. Move it out of “open questions” so it becomes a requirement:

> *“The system shall ingest from the sources listed in Appendix A at launch.”*

Issue 12: No loading/empty/error states, and no LLM provider chosen

What it says now

The SRS describes the happy path. The only empty state mentioned is the swipe deck (FR-4.8), which is next-phase. The LLM provider is described only as “provider-agnostic”.

The problem

- **States:** What does the Radar tab show for a brand-new user who has no matches yet? What if the chat fails, the CV can’t be parsed, or the user is offline? If these aren’t specified, designers and developers each invent something, and you redo work later.
- **LLM provider:** Even with an abstraction layer, you must pick a first provider. That choice drives cost, speed, language quality (Arabic and French) and privacy terms (NFR-9, AI-8).

What to write instead

- Add a short section “UI states” listing, for each main screen (Radar, Detail, Saved, Chat, Profile, Notifications), the **loading**, **empty** and **error** behaviour in one line each. For example: *Radar, empty: “Your agent is searching. First matches within 1 hour” plus a link to improve the profile.*
- Add one line: “Launch LLM provider: [name]; fallback: [name]”, and add the privacy terms to check.